

Chapter 32 — Piel–Pual Contrast Drill

BBH Chapter 32 · Pual Strong Verbs

Part A: active/passive pairs from the same root — identify stem and translate. Part B: 15 mixed forms (Piel / Pual / Hiphil / Hophal) — identify stem, conjugation, PGN, and root. Answer key is on the last page.

Piel diagnostic: Hireq / tsere under prefix + Dagesh Forte in R2. Pual diagnostic: Qibbuts under R1 + Dagesh Forte in R2 (ר rejects dagesh → compensatory lengthening to qamets: מַ, רַ, בַּ, מַ). Hophal: qibbuts under prefix consonant OR shureq for l-yod/Biconsonantal. Hiphil: Hireq under הַ (perfect); patach under prefix (yiqtol/wayyiqtol).

Part A — Active / Passive Pairs

#	Root	Form A	Stem A	Form B	Stem B	Translation A / B
1		תִּבְרַךְ (2)	מְבָרַךְ (.)			
2		תָּאֵר (2)	יֹאֵר (3)			
3		וּקְדַשְׁתָּ (2)	יִקְדֹּשׁ (3)			
4		יִולֵּד (3)	יֵלֵד (3)			
5		יִכְסֶה (3)	יִכְסֹּו (3)			

Part B — Mixed Forms: Piel / Pual / Hiphil / Hophal

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Root
6	מְבָרַךְ				
7	תִּבְרַךְ				
8	יֵלֵד				
9	יִכְלוּ				
10	יִכְסֶה				
11	יִכְסֹּו				
12	יִבְרַךְ				
13	יִגֵּד				
14	וּיִקְדֹּשׁ				
15	יִקְדֹּשׁ				
16	שָׁנָה				
17	קָדַשׁ				
18	הוֹקֵם				
19	הִקְדִּישׁ				
20	יֵאֵר				

Reflection Questions

1. The Pual diagnostic is "qibbuts under R1 + dagesh in R2." Item 6 (בְּבָרַךְ) has qamets, not qibbuts, under ב. What phonological rule explains this? Compare item 20 (מְבָרַךְ) where the aleph also rejects dagesh.
2. Items 13 (Hophal בְּבָרַךְ) and 8 (Pual בְּבָרַךְ) both start with qibbuts. How do you distinguish a Hophal from a Pual when both use qibbuts?
3. Item 4: בְּבָרַךְ is Hiphil, not Piel, even though both are active. What features identify it as Hiphil rather than Piel?

Answer Key — Part A

#	Root	Form A	Stem A	Form B	Stem B	Translation A / B
1		בְּבָרַךְ (2)	מְבָרַךְ (.)			
✓	בָּרַךְ	בְּבָרַךְ	Piel	מְבָרַךְ (.)	Pual	you bless / is blessed (בָּ → qamets)
2		בְּעָרַךְ (2)	יְעָרַךְ (3)			
✓	עָרַךְ	בְּעָרַךְ (2)	Piel	יְעָרַךְ (3)	Pual	you curse / is cursed
3		בְּקִדְּשָׁתְךָ (2)	יְקַדֵּשׁ (3)			
✓	קִדְּשׁ	בְּקִדְּשָׁתְךָ (2)	Piel	יְקַדֵּשׁ (3)	Pual	you consecrate / will be consecrated
4		בְּיֻלְדְּךָ (3)	יֻלְדְּךָ (3)			
✓	יָלַד	בְּיֻלְדְּךָ (3)	Hiphil	יֻלְדְּךָ (3)	Pual	he fathered / was born
5		בְּכִסָּה (3)	יְכַסֵּה (3)			
✓	כָּסָה	בְּכִסָּה (3)	Piel	יְכַסֵּה (3)	Pual	he covers / they were covered

Answer Key — Part B

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Root
6	מְבַרֵּךְ				
✓	מְבַרֵּךְ	Pual	Participle	ms	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ · qamets (compensatory; ■ rejects
7	תִּבְרַךְ				
✓	תִּבְרַךְ	Piel	Yiqtol	2ms	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ · tsere under prefix = Piel
8	יִלֵּד				
✓	יִלֵּד	Pual	Qatal	3ms	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ · qibbutts + dagesh in ■ = Pual
9	יִכְלוּ				
✓	יִכְלוּ	Pual	Wayyiqtol	3mp	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ · qibbutts + dagesh in ■ ■ ■; III-he 3mp
10	יִכְסֶּה				
✓	יִכְסֶּה	Piel	Yiqtol	3ms	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ · tsere (patach) prefix = Piel
11	יִכְסֹּוּ				
✓	יִכְסֹּוּ	Pual	Wayyiqtol	3mp	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ · qibbutts + dagesh in ■ ■ ■ = Pual
12	יִבְרַךְ				
✓	יִבְרַךְ	Piel	Wayyiqtol	3ms	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ · patach prefix + tsere = Piel
13	יִגַּד				
✓	יִגַּד	Hophal	Wayyiqtol	3ms	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ · qibbutts under ■ + dagesh = Hophal
14	יִקְדֹּשׁ				
✓	יִקְדֹּשׁ	Piel	Wayyiqtol	3ms	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ · patach-tsere pattern = Piel
15	יִקְדָּשׁ				
✓	יִקְדָּשׁ	Pual	Yiqtol	3ms	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ · qibbutts + dagesh = Pual
16	שָׁנָה				
✓	שָׁנָה	Piel	Perfect	3ms	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ · chiriq + tsere + dagesh in ■ ■ ■ = Piel
17	קָדַשׁ				
✓	קָדַשׁ	Pual	Perfect	3ms	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ · qibbutts + dagesh = Pual perfect
18	הוֹקֵם				
✓	הוֹקֵם	Hophal	Perfect	3ms	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ · shureq prefix = Hophal Biconsonantal
19	הִקְדִּישׁ				
✓	הִקְדִּישׁ	Hiphil	Perfect	3ms	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ · chiriq prefix = Hiphil perfect
20	יָאֵר				
✓	יָאֵר	Pual	Yiqtol	3ms	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ · qibbutts + I-aleph (rejects dagesh)